

## Definitions: Carré du Champ and Normalised Diffusion

- **Carré du Champ Operator:** For an infinitesimal generator  $\mathcal{L}$  of a Markov diffusion process, the bilinear form is defined as:

$$\Gamma_{\mathcal{L}}(f, h) := \frac{1}{2}(f\mathcal{L}h + h\mathcal{L}f - \mathcal{L}(fh)) \quad (3)$$

- **Normalised Diffusion Operator:** Approximates the geometry from discrete samples  $X \sim p$  using a Gaussian heat kernel  $w_{\epsilon}(\mathbf{y}, \mathbf{x}) = \exp\left(-\frac{\|\mathbf{y}-\mathbf{x}\|^2}{2\epsilon}\right)$ :

$$(P_{\epsilon}f)(\mathbf{y}) := \frac{(\mathcal{K}_{\epsilon}f)(\mathbf{y})}{d_{\epsilon}(\mathbf{y})}$$

- **Kernel Operator and Degree Function:**

$$(\mathcal{K}_{\epsilon}f)(\mathbf{y}) := \mathbb{E}_{X \sim p(\mathbf{x})}[w_{\epsilon}(\mathbf{y}, X)f(X)]$$

$$d_{\epsilon}(\mathbf{y}) := \mathbb{E}_{X \sim p(\mathbf{x})}[w_{\epsilon}(\mathbf{y}, X)]$$

## Derivation: Substituting $\mathcal{L}_\epsilon$ into the CDC Operator (Part 1)

- **Initial CDC Definition:**

$$\Gamma_{\mathcal{L}_\epsilon}(f, h) = \frac{1}{2}(f\mathcal{L}_\epsilon h + h\mathcal{L}_\epsilon f - \mathcal{L}_\epsilon(fh))$$

- **Substitute  $\mathcal{L}_\epsilon = \frac{1}{\epsilon}(\mathbf{I} - P_\epsilon)$  evaluated at  $y$ :**

$$\begin{aligned}\Gamma_\epsilon(f, h)(y) = \frac{1}{2\epsilon} \big[ & f(y)(h(y) - P_\epsilon h(y)) \\ & + h(y)(f(y) - P_\epsilon f(y)) \\ & - (f(y)h(y) - P_\epsilon(fh)(y)) \big]\end{aligned}$$

- **Expand and cancel scalars ( $+f(y)h(y)$  and  $-f(y)h(y)$ ):**

$$\begin{aligned}\Gamma_\epsilon(f, h)(y) = \frac{1}{2\epsilon} \big[ & f(y)h(y) - f(y)P_\epsilon h(y) \\ & - h(y)P_\epsilon f(y) + P_\epsilon(fh)(y) \big]\end{aligned}$$

## Derivation: Substituting $\mathcal{L}_\epsilon$ into the CDC Operator (Part 2)

- **Substitute definition of  $P_\epsilon g(y) = \frac{\mathbb{E}_X[w_\epsilon(y, X)g(X)]}{d_\epsilon(y)}$ :**

$$\Gamma_\epsilon(f, h)(y) = \frac{1}{2\epsilon d_\epsilon(y)} \left( f(y)h(y)d_\epsilon(y) - f(y)\mathbb{E}_X[w_\epsilon(y, X)h(X)] \right. \\ \left. - h(y)\mathbb{E}_X[w_\epsilon(y, X)f(X)] + \mathbb{E}_X[w_\epsilon(y, X)f(X)h(X)] \right)$$

- **Expand  $d_\epsilon(y) = \mathbb{E}_X[w_\epsilon(y, X)]$  and consolidate into a single expectation:**

$$\Gamma_\epsilon(f, h)(y) = \frac{1}{2\epsilon d_\epsilon(y)} \mathbb{E}_X \left[ w_\epsilon(y, X) (f(y)h(y) - f(y)h(X) \right. \\ \left. - h(y)f(X) + f(X)h(X)) \right]$$

- **Factor the polynomial to obtain the marginal CDC:**

$$\Gamma_\epsilon(f, h)(y) = \frac{\mathbb{E}_X[w_\epsilon(y, X)(f(X) - f(y))(h(X) - h(y))]}{2\epsilon \mathbb{E}_X[w_\epsilon(y, X)]} \quad (5)$$

# The Learning Problem: Marginal CDC Matching

- **Goal:** Train a neural network  $\Gamma_\epsilon^\theta$  to regress the marginal CDC operator  $\Gamma_\epsilon(f, h)$  under smoothed density  $p_Y = p * \mathcal{N}(0, \epsilon I)$ .
- **Marginal Loss:**

$$\mathcal{L}_{\text{marg}}^{\text{CDC}}(\theta) := \mathbb{E}_Y \left[ \left( \Gamma_\epsilon^\theta(Y) - \Gamma_\epsilon(f, h)(Y) \right)^2 \right] \quad (7)$$

- **Intractability:** The target  $\Gamma_\epsilon(f, h)(Y)$  requires an evaluation of the expected value across the entire dataset for every single query point, preventing scalable mini-batch training.

# Deriving Conditional CDC: Densities and Heat Kernel

- **Conditional Probability Density:** Given  $X \sim p$  and noise-perturbed point  $Y|X \sim \mathcal{N}(X, \epsilon I)$ , the density is:

$$p_Y(y|x) = (2\pi\epsilon)^{-D/2} \exp\left(-\frac{\|x - y\|^2}{2\epsilon}\right)$$

- **Relation to Heat Kernel:** The Gaussian heat kernel  $w_\epsilon(y, X)$  is strictly proportional to this conditional density:

$$w_\epsilon(y, X) = (2\pi\epsilon)^{D/2} p_Y(y|X)$$

- **Denominator Marginalisation:** The expectation of the conditional density over the prior  $p(X)$  yields the marginal density  $p_Y(y)$ :

$$d_\epsilon(y) = (2\pi\epsilon)^{D/2} \mathbb{E}_X[p_Y(y|X)] = (2\pi\epsilon)^{D/2} p_Y(y)$$

# Deriving Conditional CDC: Bayes' Rule Substitution

- **Tractable Conditional CDC Function:** Define a pairwise, constant-time target function:

$$\Gamma_{\epsilon}(f, h)(x, y) := \frac{1}{2\epsilon}(f(x) - f(y))(h(x) - h(y))$$

- **Substitute Density Relations into Marginal CDC (Eq. 5):**

$$\Gamma_{\epsilon}(f, h)(y) = \frac{(2\pi\epsilon)^{D/2} \mathbb{E}_X [p_Y(y|X) \Gamma_{\epsilon}(f, h)(X, y)]}{(2\pi\epsilon)^{D/2} p_Y(y)} = \frac{\mathbb{E}_X [p_Y(y|X) \Gamma_{\epsilon}(f, h)(X, y)]}{p_Y(y)} \quad (8)$$

- **Apply Bayes' Theorem:** Expand the expectation and substitute the posterior density

$$p_{X|Y}(x|y) = \frac{p_Y(y|x)p(x)}{p_Y(y)}:$$

$$\begin{aligned} \Gamma_{\epsilon}(f, h)(y) &= \int \Gamma_{\epsilon}(f, h)(x, y) \frac{p_Y(y|x)p(x)}{p_Y(y)} dx \\ &= \int \Gamma_{\epsilon}(f, h)(x, y) p_{X|Y}(x|y) dx \end{aligned}$$

- **Final Conditional Expectation:**

$$\Gamma_{\epsilon}(f, h)(y) = \mathbb{E}_{X|Y} [\Gamma_{\epsilon}(f, h)(X, y) \mid Y = y] \quad (9)$$

# The Tractable Objective: Conditional CDC Matching

- **Conditional Loss Formulation:** Replace the marginal target with the constant-time conditional target, sampled jointly over the data  $X$  and the applied noise  $Y$ :

$$\mathcal{L}_{cond}^{CDC}(\theta) := \mathbb{E}_{X, Y|X} \left[ \left( \Gamma_{\epsilon}^{\theta}(Y) - \Gamma_{\epsilon}(f, h)(X, Y) \right)^2 \right] \quad (10)$$

- **Theorem 3.1 (Gradient Equivalence):** The conditional loss equals the marginal loss up to a constant  $C$  which is independent of the network parameters  $\theta$ :

$$\mathcal{L}_{cond}^{CDC}(\theta) = \mathcal{L}_{marg}^{CDC}(\theta) + C \implies \nabla_{\theta} \mathcal{L}_{cond}^{CDC}(\theta) = \nabla_{\theta} \mathcal{L}_{marg}^{CDC}(\theta)$$

- **Computational Result:** Network optimisation bypasses explicit dataset-wide kernel construction and pairwise distance matrices, decomposing over independent mini-batches.

## Proof of Theorem 3.1: Setup and Expansion

- **Variable Definition:** Let  $Z$  be the deterministic random variable representing the conditional CDC target, where  $X \sim p$  and  $Y \mid X \sim \mathcal{N}(X, \epsilon I)$ :

$$Z := \Gamma_\epsilon(f, h)(X, Y)$$

- **Expectation Identity:** From Equation 9, the conditional expectation of  $Z$  given  $Y$  evaluates exactly to the marginal CDC:

$$\mathbb{E}_{X|Y}[Z \mid Y] = \Gamma_\epsilon(f, h)(Y)$$

- **Law of Total Expectation:** The unconditional expectation of the loss is rewritten as the expectation of the conditional expectation given  $Y$ :

$$\mathcal{L}_{cond}^{CDC}(\theta) = \mathbb{E}_{X,Y} \left[ \left( \Gamma_\epsilon^\theta(Y) - Z \right)^2 \right] = \mathbb{E}_Y \left[ \mathbb{E}_{X|Y} \left[ \left( \Gamma_\epsilon^\theta(Y) - Z \right)^2 \mid Y \right] \right]$$



## Proof of Theorem 3.1: Bias-Variance Decomposition

- **Decomposition:** For a random variable  $Z$  and a constant  $c$ , the mean squared error decomposes as  $\mathbb{E}[(c - Z)^2] = (c - \mathbb{E}[Z])^2 + \text{Var}(Z)$ . When conditioned on  $Y$ , the network prediction  $\Gamma_\epsilon^\theta(Y)$  acts as a deterministic constant  $c$ :

$$\mathbb{E}_{X|Y} \left[ \left( \Gamma_\epsilon^\theta(Y) - Z \right)^2 \mid Y \right] = \left( \Gamma_\epsilon^\theta(Y) - \mathbb{E}_{X|Y}[Z \mid Y] \right)^2 + \text{Var}_{X|Y}(Z \mid Y)$$

- **Substitution and Final Derivation:**

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{L}_{cond}^{CDC}(\theta) &= \mathbb{E}_Y \left[ \left( \Gamma_\epsilon^\theta(Y) - \mathbb{E}_{X|Y}[Z \mid Y] \right)^2 + \text{Var}_{X|Y}(Z \mid Y) \right] \\ &= \mathbb{E}_Y \left[ \left( \Gamma_\epsilon^\theta(Y) - \Gamma_\epsilon(f, h)(Y) \right)^2 \right] + \mathbb{E}_Y [\text{Var}_{X|Y}(Z \mid Y)] \\ &= \mathcal{L}_{marg}^{CDC}(\theta) + \mathbb{E}_Y [\text{Var}_{X|Y}(Z \mid Y)] \end{aligned}$$

- **Conclusion:** The constant  $C = \mathbb{E}_Y[\text{Var}_{X|Y}(Z \mid Y)]$  depends only on the data distribution and noise, not on  $\theta$ . Hence, the gradients are identical.

## Derivation: Matrix-Valued Conditional CDC Target

- **Scalar Conditional CDC (Section 3.1):** For any scalar functions  $f, h : \mathcal{M} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ , the pairwise target is:

$$\Gamma_{\epsilon}(f, h)(X, Y) := \frac{1}{2\epsilon} (f(X) - f(Y))(h(X) - h(Y))$$

- **Ambient Coordinate Functions (Section 3.3):** To recover the full metric tensor  $\mathbf{\Gamma}_{\epsilon} \in \mathbb{R}^{D \times D}$ , apply the CDC to the ambient coordinate functions. Let  $f$  be the  $i$ -th coordinate  $X_i$ , and  $h$  be the  $j$ -th coordinate  $X_j$ :

$$\Gamma_{\epsilon}(x_i, x_j)(X, Y) = \frac{1}{2\epsilon} (X_i - Y_i)(X_j - Y_j)$$

- **Matrix Vectorisation:** The scalar output for coordinates  $i$  and  $j$  defines the  $(i, j)$ -th element of the target matrix  $\mathbf{Z}$ . Computing this for all  $i, j \in \{1, \dots, D\}$  yields the outer product:

$$\mathbf{Z}_{ij} = \frac{1}{2\epsilon} (X_i - Y_i)(X_j - Y_j) \implies \mathbf{Z} = \frac{1}{2\epsilon} (X - Y)(X - Y)^T$$

- **Matrix-Valued Loss (Eq. 11):** Substituting this aggregated target  $\mathbf{Z}$  into the conditional loss yields:

$$\mathcal{L}_{cond}^{Riem} := \mathbb{E}_{X, Y | X} \left[ \left\| \mathbf{\Gamma}_{\epsilon}^{\theta}(Y) - \frac{1}{2\epsilon} (X - Y)(X - Y)^T \right\|_F^2 \right]$$